

Self-Introduction for CS526

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How many programming classes have you taken?

This semester, I am taking CS520 Information Structures with Java, CS665 Software Design and Patterns, and CS526 Data Structures and Algorithms.

Before, I had taken classes in BASIC, C, computer fundamentals, web analytics, etc.

Do you know Java or Python or both?

I started learning and using Python in February 2025 during my master's program at Florida State University. I have practically applied Python to several projects:

- **2025:** a stock investment profit calculator; an automatic screen-content recognition and computer-control program.
- **2026:** my personal web research platform, www.chenquant.com; a private financial research terminal containing approximately 20,000 lines of code.

I am also currently learning and using Java through my BU coursework.

What year are you in?

I started my Software Development Master's program in Fall 2026; this is my first-year.

What is your experience level with algorithms and data structures?

My background includes a bachelor's degree in Physics, an MBA, and a master's degree in Economics, all of which are closely connected to quantitative analysis, problem-solving, and algorithmic thinking.

I previously ran a company where I worked extensively with cost, profit, customer decision-making, and benefit evaluation. From 2018 to 2022, I independently managed a construction project to build a 6,000-square-foot house. I applied systematic and quantitative approaches to construction engineering and builder-team management to ensure daily work quality, reliability, and efficiency.

I have some practical programming experience, but I would consider my formal experience with data structures and algorithms to be developing. I hope to strengthen my foundation in this area through CS526.